Try it at the table

How Velcro Works

Gather your things, then try each one. Guess first. Then look closely and write or draw what you saw.

What you need

- ☐ two strips of hook-and-loop tape
- ☐ a magnifying glass
- ☐ a small cloth bag or sock
- ☐ a few small toys to put in the bag
- ☐ a pipe cleaner and a scrap of yarn
- ☐ an old comb or toothbrush
- ☐ paper and pencil

TRY 1 Where did the idea come from?

1. After a walk outdoors, look closely at your socks.
2. Did any seeds hitch a ride?
3. Look at one with a magnifying glass for hooks.

I THINK…

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I SAW…

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TRY 2 How do you make a tiny hook?

1. Bend a pipe cleaner into a small loop.
2. Open one side a little so it becomes a hook.
3. Can your hook catch a loop of yarn?

I THINK…

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I SAW…

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TRY 3 Why does a peel open so easily?

1. Press two strips together.
2. Slide them apart sideways, then peel one corner.
3. Which one takes less push?
4. Listen to each.

I THINK…

I SAW…

TRY 4 Why do old strips lose their grip?

1. Find a fuzzy strip on an old shoe or bag.
2. Comb it gently with an old comb or toothbrush, then test the grip again.

I THINK…

I SAW…